

NGIGI SIMON GATHARIKI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Engineer and Technical Lead with 5+ years of experience building and operating scalable backend systems, APIs, and data pipelines used in production by distributed teams.

Skilled in designing reliable, high-availability services, improving observability, and delivering measurable performance and scalability improvements. Comfortable owning systems end-to-end, collaborating across time zones, and translating complex technical requirements into clear, actionable solutions.

Known for strong communication, product thinking, and a pragmatic approach to building secure, maintainable software that delivers real business impact.

EXPERIENCE

Technical Lead, *Scytale Systems*

October 2025 – Present

- Leading architecture and development of a full-stack AML compliance platform covering screening, transaction monitoring, risk scoring, investigations, and regulatory reporting.
- Designing the core AML rules engine and alerting workflows to support financial crime detection and regulatory compliance.
- Building real-time and batch ETL pipelines for large-scale financial data processing and analytics.
- Driving cross-functional collaboration with QA, product, and business teams to deliver a production-ready compliance platform.

Software Engineer, *SwitchLink Africa*

February 2023 – April 2025

- Architected and deployed an OpenSearch-based observability platform, replacing Dynatrace and significantly reducing monitoring costs.
- Designed and implemented multiple cross-border payment integrations across Ethiopia, Tanzania, Uganda, India, Japan, and China.

- Led the migration of the API gateway from Javalin to Spring, improving performance, reliability, and scalability.
- Increased transaction throughput from <1,000 to 4,333 TPM and reduced worst-case TAT from 30 minutes to <50 seconds.
- Delivered new payment termination and mobile money integrations, expanding regional payout capabilities across East Africa.

Part-time Lecturer, *University of Embu*

January 2022 – August 2022

- Taught Introduction to Cloud Computing and Desktop Publishing, delivering practical and theoretical training to undergraduate students.

Software Developer, *University of Embu*

April 2021 – April 2022

- Built internal web platforms including contract management, student onboarding, leave tracking, and LMS analytics.
- Supported Moodle e-learning infrastructure and improved system reliability and reporting.

Software Developer, *Rivest Enterprises*

July 2018 – October 2020

- Developed a mobile payment application for a trading platform.
- Implemented school management systems, improving operational efficiency and real-time communication.

TECHNICAL STACK & SKILLS

Backend & Systems:

Java, Spring Boot, Node.js, REST APIs, Microservices

Distributed Systems & Messaging:

Kafka, RabbitMQ, event-driven architecture

Cloud & DevOps:

AWS, GCP, Docker, CI/CD (GitHub Actions)

Data & Storage:

PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis

Observability & Reliability:

OpenSearch, ELK, system monitoring, performance optimization

EDUCATION

Kirinyaga University,**September 2014 – April 2019**

Bachelor of Science degree in Information Technology

REFERENCES

1. David Njogu
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